

JEAN DE DIEU MANISHIMWE

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Spark Microgrants

Hiring Team

Application: Manager, Data Systems & IT

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Manager, Data Systems & IT role. I bring over ten years in technology, including infrastructure, cybersecurity, disaster recovery and IT governance in Rwanda's banking sector, and hands-on data work in international development and digital health.

At NCBA Bank Rwanda, I lead infrastructure for over 100 servers, own disaster recovery and business continuity, and manage more than ten technology vendors. I led infrastructure integration across 40+ branches during the Cogebanque–Equity Bank merger with no customer-facing downtime, and I have worked on the upgrades of NCBA's T24 core banking, IBPS and NCBA NOW systems. I led NCBA Rwanda's ISO/IEC 20000 certification as ITSM Lead, working with the Rwanda infrastructure team and NCBA Group managers. I hold ISO/IEC 27001 Lead Implementer and ISO/IEC 20000 Lead Implementer and Lead Auditor credentials. On the data side, I have over seven years in database management (DBMS), built ETL integrations for the Africa Digital Health Networks platform, and produced Power BI dashboards for private-sector clients.

Spark's model depends on reliable data from many villages across several countries. At ADHN, I integrated health data across countries through FHIR and DHIS2, and at RTI I supported an international development programme across six countries and trained more than 50 staff. I also work within the requirements of the National Bank of Rwanda, the Cyber Security Authority and Rwanda's personal data protection law (Law No. 058/2021). I would apply the same discipline to Spark's data across Rwanda, Uganda, Malawi and Ghana, checking each country's requirements before data moves.

I want to be direct about two gaps. First, I am willing to learn GIS and have not yet used it in a project. Second, I am completing an MBA in Artificial Intelligence at Nexford University, expected in 2027; my completed degree is a BSc in Computer Science from African Leadership University. I have coordinated engineers and stakeholders across countries at ADHN and across the NCBA Group, and I am ready to take on direct supervision of teams across Spark's four countries.

I would welcome the chance to discuss how I can help Spark own its impact data and turn it into decisions that improve programme delivery. Thank you for your consideration.

Yours sincerely,

Jean de Dieu Manishimwe